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**Elite: Dangerous reviewed**

Read the review of Elite: Dangerous – the new space simulator on the block
<http://dgit.in/eldang>

7790 isn't that ahead of the R7 240. In fact, the performance isn't suited for the high end configuration at all but when you do dial the settings down to medium then all new AAA titles become playable. There will definitely be instances of stuttering when experiencing any scenario with too many moving elements but overall this card should be more than enough for HTPCs and folks wanting to spend some money and get gaming at a moderate configuration.

The holy grail of FPS count (which is 60 FPS in case you were wondering) will be difficult to achieve but for roughly a year down the line you shouldn't face any major issues. The card shares a similar build quality as the previous XFX card that we looked at. This one does require a 6 pin PCIE power supply. However, you might want to check out the Editor's pick if your budget falls in this segment.

Above ₹20,000

No, no it isn't XFX this time but ASUS that gets the VFM award in the top-most segment. Also, it's an NVIDIA card this time. ASUS' GTX 760 DC2OC is an overclocked version of the GTX 760 which performs better than some of its slightly expensive counterparts. But the pattern (if you'd have

noticed) is still prevalent where the cheapest card in a segment wins. Performance wise the card is quite good and scores above 30 FPS in most gaming benchmarks except Hitman Absolution. Now that's a game benchmark which manages to bring even the flagship cards to their knees so we wouldn't worry about that. As with any NVIDIA card, even this one has a lacklustre performance in OpenCL benchmarks. So folks interested in harnessing the parallel performance abilities of a GPU might keep away from it, however, NVIDIA cards excel at games compared to the AMD counterparts.

ASUS cards are quite durable and this card has the DC2 cooler with plenty of heat-pipes in direct contact with



MSI R9 270X Hawk

the die. This card isn't bad at all since it offers good performance and is one of the more durable cards we've seen. The new cards feature Cooltech fans which are quite efficient at generating static pressure.

segment of the comparison test this particular card scores the highest when it comes to the average score regarding all three major parameters. With a performance score of 79, it is the best performing card in the middle segment with the ASUS R9 270X lagging behind by just one point. This makes the VFM scores for both cards ridiculously similar but the aspect that tilted the scales in favour of the MSI card was that it has a better build quality than the ASUS card. And this includes the cooler which managed to keep the card at a lower temperature at both load and idle conditions.

Editor's pick

For this year's Editor's pick we've decided to go ahead with the MSI R9 207X. There are numerous reasons behind

This doesn't mean that the ASUS card doesn't have a great build quality, it's just that MSI went a little overboard with this one while only charging



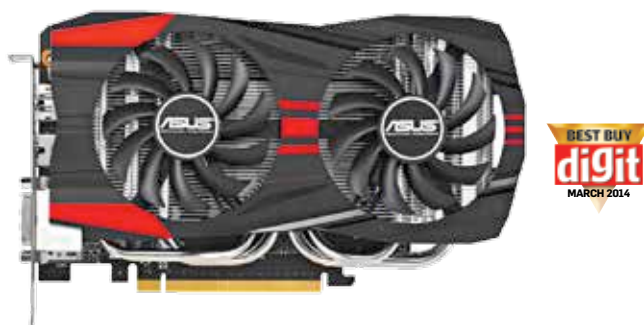
Powercolor R9 270X PCS+

a lower price premium when compared to the ASUS card. They both have a three year warranty and the packaging is quite good with foam cushions that offer a snug fit. Finally, the MSI R9 270X Hawk has a dual bios feature, v-check points and is clocked 30 MHz higher than the ASUS card.

Two cards worthy of mention this year are the NVIDIA GTX 750 Ti and a ZOTAC GTX 750 Ti OC. The maxwell based cards are the first under the new architecture and the NVIDIA reference card doesn't even require external power. While the ZOTAC card performs ever so slightly better than the reference card it unfortunately, requires a 6 pin power supply. This narrows down the usage scenarios by a little amount.

Now that you've read about the winners, we'd like to hear your opinions regarding the same. Do write in to us and don't forget to catch the individual reviews of all these cards online on our website.

Note: The prices mentioned in this test are excluding sales and other applicable regional taxes. Also, lifetime warranty is decided by the distributors and varies from country to country. **d**



ASUS GTX 760 DC2OC